

The Shadow Harvester

Realismo Magico

Chapter I: The Discovery in the Shadows

Night fell over the rooftops with the heavy weight of lead and salt. The wind swept through the narrow alleys, carrying the distant echo of convent bells.

Inside the study, parchments accumulated over decades gave off the scent of mold and dried oak gall ink. Every document represented the preserved memory of an era when decisions were made in secrecy, far from public view.

The protagonist ran a thumb along the worn leather spine of the volume. Cold brass rivets held the patina of constant use. This was no ordinary ledger; it was the key to an investigation that threatened the delicate balance of the harbor.

At three in the morning, a shadow crossed the skylight of the upper gallery. Footsteps on the pine floorboards creaked with the rhythm of someone avoiding detection.

Chapter II: The Hidden Truth

The oil lamp cast flickering shadows across the stone wall.

Unfolding the inner blueprint of the archive, the red wax seals cracked with a dry snap. Marginal notes, written in fine pen and diplomatic code, revealed unrecorded transfers of funds missing from official ledgers.

"If this document surfaces before dawn," the scribe whispered, looking toward the window, "the Court will seal the property immediately."

The only response was tense silence, broken only by the sea wind whistling through the timber cracks.

Chapter III: The Judgment

Dawn brought a cold, golden light across the estuary.

The key figures gathered in the main hall before the opening of the courts. No room remained for doubt or superfluous explanations. The facts recorded in the codex were undeniable.

The protagonist signed the retention copy, locked the walnut case with an iron key, and walked toward the main pier. The morning tide vessel was already casting off lines.

Nothing would ever be the same again in the alleys of the old port, but justice, quiet and firm, had been satisfied.

END OF THE NOVELLA

Chapter IV: The Night Watch

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